

Checklist

Phishing Awareness & Response

Before Clicking a Link or Opening an Attachment

- ☐ Was I expecting this email, link, or attachment?
- ☐ Do I recognize the sender?
- ☐ Does the sender's email address match the person or organization it claims to be from?
- ☐ Is the message creating unusual urgency or pressure?
- ☐ Is it asking for a username, password, financial information, or other sensitive data?
- ☐ If the message appears work-related, have I verified the request with the sender through a separate trusted method?
- ☐ If the message contains a website link, have I checked that the URL is correct and uses [https://](#)?
- ☐ If anything feels suspicious, have I stopped and contacted the IT Help Desk?

Warning Signs: Something Feels Funny

- ☐ I logged in and was immediately sent back to the login page.
- ☐ A website does not behave as expected.
- ☐ I received an unexpected package, delivery, payroll, greeting card, or similar message.
- ☐ I received a document claiming to contain sensitive information that I was not expecting.

Warning Signs: Something Looks Funny

- ☐ An attachment opens with an unusual error or does not contain what was promised.

- ☐ I am prompted to enable macros, install software, update a driver, or install a new media player.
- ☐ A website looks familiar, but the URL is different.
- ☐ I found an unknown USB drive, CD, DVD, or other removable media.

Warning Signs: Something Sounds Funny

- ☐ Someone claiming to be from IT asks for my username or password.
- ☐ A caller says they need immediate access to fix an issue I did not report.
- ☐ A new vendor or unfamiliar person wants information about our systems, software, or environment.
- ☐ Someone makes an unusual request while claiming to represent facilities, management, IT, or another department.

If I Already Clicked or Opened Something Suspicious

- ☐ Stop interacting with the message, website, or attachment.
- ☐ Do not enter any additional information.
- ☐ Contact the IT Help Desk immediately.
- ☐ Tell IT what I clicked or opened and what happened afterward.
- ☐ Report whether I entered a username, password, or other sensitive information.
- ☐ Follow IT instructions for password changes, device checks, or other response actions.
- ☐ Report the incident quickly so IT can help protect other users and prevent the issue from spreading.

If I Did Not Click the Link or Attachment

- ☐ Report the suspicious message to IT or through the organization's phishing-reporting process.
- ☐ Do not forward the suspicious message to coworkers unless IT instructs me to do so.
- ☐ Keep the message available if IT needs to review it.
- ☐ Remember that other employees may have received the same attack.
- ☐ Be alert for follow-up attempts from the same or a similar sender.

Information That Should Be Reported

- ☐ Suspicious emails asking for usernames, passwords, banking information, software details, or other sensitive information.
- ☐ Unexpected emails containing links or attachments.
- ☐ Attempts by unauthorized people to access a computer, account, system, or workspace.
- ☐ Requests involving protected health information (PHI) or other confidential information.
- ☐ Suspicious phone calls, messages, websites, or removable media.

Key Rules to Remember

- ☐ Do not click unexpected links.
- ☐ Do not open unexpected attachments.
- ☐ Never give your username or password to another person.
- ☐ Verify unusual requests through a trusted communication channel.
- ☐ When something feels, looks, or sounds suspicious, report it.
- ☐ When in doubt, contact the IT Help Desk.

IT Help Desk: _____

Phishing Report Method: _____

Emergency/After-Hours Contact: _____